

C O N V E N T I O N

**THE PATH TO A DEMOCRATIC,
PROSPEROUS REPUBLIC IN IRAN**

The **Free Iran Convention 2025** brings together Iranian scholars, activists, professionals, and community leaders to outline a clear vision for ending dictatorship and building a democratic, secular, and non-nuclear republic in Iran.

This landmark all-day event will feature Iranian voices from across the United States, joined by prominent U.S. and international dignitaries.

Participants will explore the current situation in Iran, the growing momentum for change, and the blueprint for a free and just future.

Throughout the day, the Convention will explore the forces driving change inside Iran and the shape of the alternative emerging to replace clerical rule.

Saturday, November 15, 2025

9:30 am to 5:00 pm

**Hyatt Regency Hotel
Capitol Hill, Washington, DC**

#FreeIranConvention2025



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Additional information is on file with the Department of Justice, Washington, D.C.

AGENDA

FREE IRAN CONVENTION 2025

WASHINGTON, DC

NOVEMBER 15, 2025

MORNING SESSIONS

Registration	8:00 – 9:30 am
Convention begins, opening remarks Ms. Soona Samsami, U.S. Representative, NCRI	9:30 – 9:40 am
Panel: Society Ripe for Change in Iran <i>Why Change Has Become Inevitable</i> Kazem Kazerounian, Ph.D., Dean, UConn College of Engineering (2012–2024) Hossein Saiedian, Ph.D., Professor at the University of Kansas Sima Yazdani, BSE, MS, Executive Director of AI Technology & Solutions Ashraf Zadshir, MD, is a physician, educator, and clinical researcher in California	9:40 – 10:25 am
Panel: Iranian Women & the Legacy of Resistance <i>From Repression to Leadership in Charting the Future</i> Hannane Amanpour, Esq. an accomplished attorney Dr. Azadeh Sami, board-certified pediatrician in Fairfax, Virginia Dr. Ramesh Sepehrrad, distinguished scholar-practitioner, published author Dr. Azadeh Zangeneh, an internal medicine physician based in Cleveland, Ohio	10:25 – 11:15 am
The Voices from Iran Shirin Nariman, MC for this section which brings the audience directly inside Iran's struggle for freedom	11:15 – 11:50 am
Panel: The Power of Youth in Driving Change <i>A Defiant Generation Shaping Iran's Democratic Movement</i> Mohammadreza Hesami, senior medical dosimetrist at the U.S. Oncology Network Mahrana Mohammadi, J.D. Candidate at Penn State Dickinson Law Ryan Nasir, Computer Science student based in San Diego, California Seena Saiedian, J.D. Candidate at the University of Virginia School of Law Nicole Shariati, a cybersecurity consultant based in Denver, Colorado.	11:50 am – 12:35 pm
Panel: Prospects for Change, Plan for Transition <i>Roadmap for the Overthrow of the Regime, Establishing Democracy</i> Dr. Firouz Daneshgari, executive surgeon-scientist, Case Western Reserve University Reza M. Nemovi, design engineer, CALTECH Dr. Behzad Raofi, the NASA Lunar Human Landing System Saeid Sajadi, MD, an Internal Medicine Specialist Farideh Sedighi, MSCS, Software Engineer	12:35 – 13:30 pm
Lunch Break	13:30 – 14:30 pm

AFTERNOON SESSIONS

Afternoon Session, welcoming remarks Dr. Sofey Saidi, Accomplished Scholar-practitioner in Int'l Relations, Global Governance, and Conflict Resolution	14:30 – 14:35 pm
Keynote Address Mrs. Maryam Rajavi, President-elect, National Council of Resistance of Iran	14:35 – 14:55 pm
Hon. Mike Pompeo, 70th U.S. Secretary of State	15:00 – 15:20 pm
The Rt. Hon. John Bercow, Speaker of the U.K. House of Commons (2009–2019)	15:20 – 15:35 pm
A conversation of Prof. Mohammad H. Tasooji with Prof. Morteza Charib Hans W. Liepmann Prof. of Aeronautics & Medical Engineering, CALTECH	15:35 – 15:50 pm
Amb. Carla Sands, U.S. Ambassador to Denmark (2017–2021)	16:00 – 16:10 pm
Hon. Patrick Kennedy (D-RI), Former member of U.S. Congress	16:10 – 16:20 pm
Shaping Iran's Future: The People's Choice for Democracy Professor Hossein Sadeghpour, Harvard University	16:20 – 16:35 pm
Guy Benson, National Broadcast Journalist	16:35 – 16:50 pm
Closing remarks	16:50 – 16:55 pm
Declaration of the Convention	16:55 – 17:00 pm



The Ten-Point Plan for Iran's Future was first presented by Maryam Rajavi in December 2006 at a session of the Council of Europe. This plan encapsulates the aspirations of the Iranian people and the Iranian Resistance for a future Iran: a pluralistic republic based

on the separation of religion and state, gender equality, the abolition of the death penalty, peace, coexistence, the elimination of double oppression against Iran's ethnic and national minorities, and a non-nuclear Iran. This plan has been repeatedly recognized by resolutions from the U.S. Congress, several European parliaments, and prominent international figures as a vision for a free Iran.

- 1** Rejection of velayat-e faqih (absolute clerical rule). Affirmation of the people's sovereignty in a republic founded on universal suffrage and pluralism;
- 2** Freedom of speech, freedom of political parties, freedom of assembly, freedom of the press and the internet. Dissolution and disbanding of the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), the terrorist Qods Force, plainclothes groups, the unpopular Bassij, the Ministry of Intelligence, Council of the Cultural Revolution, and all suppressive patrols and institutions in cities, villages, schools, universities, offices, and factories;
- 3** Commitment to individual and social freedoms and rights in accordance with the Universal Declaration of Humans Rights. Disbanding all agencies in charge of censorship and inquisition. Seeking justice for massacred political prisoners, prohibition of torture, and the abolishment of the death penalty;
- 4** Separation of religion and state, and freedom of religions and faiths;
- 5** Complete gender equality in the realms of political, social, cultural, and economic rights, and equal participation of women in political leadership. Abolishment of any form of discrimination; the right to choose one's own clothing freely; the right to freely marry and divorce, and to obtain education and employment. Prohibition of all forms of exploitation against women under any pretext;
- 6** An independent judiciary and legal system consistent with international standards based on the presumption of innocence, the right to defense counsel, right of appeal, and the right to be tried in a public court. Full independence of judges. Abolishment of the mullahs' Sharia law and dissolution of Islamic Revolutionary Courts;
- 7** Autonomy for and removal of double injustices against Iranian nationalities and ethnicities consistent with the NCRI's plan for the autonomy of Iranian Kurdistan;
- 8** Justice and equal opportunities in the realms of employment and entrepreneurship for all people of Iran in a free market economy. Restoration of the rights of blue-collar workers, farmers, nurses, white-collar workers, teachers, and retirees;
- 9** Protection and rehabilitation of the environment, which has been massacred under the rule of the mullahs;
- 10** A non-nuclear Iran that is also devoid of weapons of mass destruction. Peace, co-existence, and international and regional cooperation.



National Council of Resistance of Iran (NCRI), a broad coalition of democratic Iranian organizations, groups and personalities, was founded in 1981 in Tehran upon the initiative of Massoud Rajavi, the Leader of the Iranian Resistance.

Parliament in Exile

The NCRI has more than 400 members, including representatives of ethnic and religious minorities such as the Kurds, Baluchis, Armenians, Jews and Zoroastrians, representing a broad spectrum of political tendencies in Iran. Acting as parliament in exile, the NCRI aims to establish a democratic, secular and coalition government in Iran. Women comprise 50% of the council's members.

Democratic decision-making

All members of the Council have one vote. All decisions are adopted by a simple majority.

Six-month provisional government

The council's 25 committees form the basis for a provisional coalition government once the mullahs are toppled. Chairing each committee is a prominent political personality who is an expert in the field.

The provisional government will be in power for only six months and its main responsibility is to hold free and fair elections for a National Legislative and Constituent Assembly and to transfer power to the representatives of the people of Iran.

President-elect

The president-elect of the NCRI is Mrs. Maryam Rajavi. Her mandate is to oversee the peaceful transfer of power to the Iranian people following the regime's overthrow. Mrs. Rajavi was born in 1953 in Tehran and has a degree in metallurgy. The shah executed one of her sisters, Narges, and the Khomeini regime murdered another, Massoumeh, who was pregnant at the time. Mrs. Rajavi was a leader of the anti-shah student movement in the 1970s.



National Solidarity Front, a leap forward

In 2002, NCRI adopted a plan to form the “National Solidarity Front to Overthrow Religious Dictatorship in Iran.” The front was designed as a platform to encompass all Iranians who believe in a republican system of government and “are campaigning for a democratic, independent and secular regime.”

Platform

Human Rights:

The NCRI pledges to uphold the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and all international covenants on human rights, including “freedom of association, freedom of thought and expression, media, political parties, trade unions, councils, religions and denominations, freedom of profession, and prevention of any violation of individual and social rights and freedoms.”

Women:

The NCRI recognizes “the right of women to vote and stand as candidates in all elections, and the right to vote in all referenda,” “the right to employment and free selection of profession, and the right to hold any public office, including the presidency or judgeship,” “the right to freely choose clothing,” and “the right to use, without discrimination, all instructional, educational, athletic, and artistic resources; the right to participate in all athletic competitions and artistic activities.”

Economy:

The council accepts national capitalism and the bazaar, private ownership and enterprise, as well as private investment. It emphasizes the need to utilize the latest scientific and technical achievements and views relations with industrial countries necessary to reconstruct Iran’s economy.

Freedom of Religion:

The NCRI believes in the separation of Church and State. According to its ratifications, “all forms of discrimination against the followers of various religions and denominations in the enjoyment of their individual and social rights are prohibited. No citizen shall enjoy any privileges or be subject to any deprivations with respect to nomination for election, suffrage, employment, education, becoming a judge or any other individual or social rights, for reason of belief or non-belief in particular religion or denomination.”

National Minorities:

The NCRI recognizes the rights of ethnic and national minorities. It adopted a plan for the autonomy of Iranian Kurdistan, specifying that “the administration of all affairs of the autonomous region of Kurdistan,” except for those related to foreign policy, national defense, national security and foreign trade, “fall within the authority of the autonomous organs.”

International Relations:

The council’s foreign policy is based on independence, respect for the United Nations Charter and international conventions and treaties, good neighborliness, international and regional cooperation and non-interference in the internal affairs of other countries. The NCRI supports the Middle East peace process and is committed to maintaining and protecting peace and tranquility in the region and condemns any aggression and expansionism. The council opposes nuclear proliferation and the production of weapons of mass destruction and ballistic missiles.



Founded in 1965, the People's Mojahedin Organization of Iran (PMOI/MEK) is the largest, best-organized Iranian opposition movement and the principal member of the National Council of Resistance of Iran (NCRI), Iran's democratic parliament-in-exile.

Together, the NCRI and MEK advocate a secular, democratic, non-nuclear republic, gender equality, freedom of religion and expression, free elections, respect for the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, and peace across the Middle East. The NCRI's President-elect is Mrs. Maryam Rajavi.

MEK: Leading Force of the Democratic Opposition: Since the early days after the 1979 revolution, the MEK has been at the forefront of resistance to Iran's ruling theocracy—quickly becoming the regime's primary target. Tehran views the MEK as an existential threat due to its social base inside Iran and its ability to undermine the regime's extremist ideology, especially among the youth. The MEK's modern, tolerant, and democratic interpretation of Islam directly counters the velayat-e faqih doctrine that underpins the clerical dictatorship.

MEK's Network Inside Iran: The MEK maintains a vast and expanding network inside Iran, operating through agile, decentralized "Resistance Units" active in cities, towns, and rural areas across all 31 provinces. These units play a critical strategic role in the movement's roadmap to end clerical rule. They organize and coordinate protests, strikes, and other anti-regime campaigns; sustain public defiance, especially among the younger generation that views the MEK as a viable democratic alternative.

Main Victim of Regime Repression: No movement has paid a higher price. In 1988, more than 30,000 political prisoners—over 90% of them MEK members—were massacred under Khomeini's direct order. Since 1981, over 100,000 MEK members and supporters have been killed, and countless others remain imprisoned in Iran's notorious jails. Most political prisoners executed or sentenced after the 2009 uprising were affiliated with the MEK.

MEK's Role in Exposing Iran's Nuclear Weapons Program: The MEK's intelligence network inside Iran played a decisive role in uncovering Tehran's clandestine nuclear weapons efforts. MEK revelations in 2002 led to the first International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) inspections of the Natanz uranium enrichment and Arak heavy-water facilities—triggering international scrutiny that has continued ever since. A majority of subsequent IAEA inspections have centered on sites first exposed by the MEK, significantly enhancing global security.

Exposing the IRGC's Terror Network: The MEK has also been instrumental in exposing operations of the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) and its Qods Force. MEK-provided, actionable intelligence uncovered terrorist networks across the region, saving lives in Iraq and disrupting multiple plots orchestrated by the Iranian regime.

4000 Legislators from 50 Countries Endorse Maryam Rajavi's 10-Point Plan

Over 4000 legislators from 84 parliaments across 50 countries have issued a statement backing the Ten-Point Plan of Mrs. Maryam Rajavi, President-elect of the National Council of Resistance of Iran (NCRI). This collective endorsement includes majorities from 34 legislative bodies, underscoring the global consensus for supporting democratic change in Iran. Prominent signatories include members of the UK House of Commons and House of Lords, the Italian Senate and House of Representatives, and parliaments from Norway, Slovenia, Iceland, Estonia, Lithuania, Malta, Moldova, Costa Rica, Yemen, and Jordan.

About 130 former heads of state have supported Mary Rajavi's Ten-Point Plan: "We believe the Ten-Point Plan articulated by the NCRI President, Mrs. Maryam Rajavi, deserves support. Its commitment to free elections, freedom of assembly and expression, abolition of the death penalty, gender equality, separation of religion and state, autonomy for Iran's ethnicities, and a non-nuclear Iran is in line with our own democratic values."

More than 103 Nobel Laureates have issued a powerful joint letter to UN Secretary General António Guterres. They aligned their statement with growing global recognition of the Iranian Resistance, particularly the Ten-Point Plan proposed by Mrs. Maryam Rajavi, President-elect of the National Council of Resistance of Iran (NCRI).



The National Council of Resistance of Iran (NCRI) has played a pivotal role in advancing peace and security by exposing Tehran's clandestine nuclear weapons program. Chief among them was the 2002 revelations about the Natanz uranium enrichment facility and the Arak heavy water plant. These disclosures triggered a series of investigations and inspections by the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA), bringing Iran's nuclear file to the forefront of global security deliberations.



NCRI's Key Nuclear Revelations

August 2002	Natanz Uranium Enrichment
August 2002	Arak Heavy Water Facility
February 2003	Kala Electric Company in Tehran
March 2003	Lavizan-Shian Facility
May 2003	Lashkar Abad Laser Enrichment
November 2004	Lavizan II
September & November 2005	Khojir tunnels
December 2005	Qom underground enrichment
February 2008	Mojdeh Nuclear Command Ctr
September 2009	METFAZ underground Site
September 2010	Abyek underground enrichment
April 2011	TABA centrifuge parts production
July 2011	SPND nuclear bomb making
February 2015	Lavizan-3 enrichment facility
April 2017	Plan 6 in Parchin complex
October 2020	New Nuclear Weaponization Site in Sorkheh Hesar
December 2024	Re-activating Sanjarian Site
January 2025	SPND: Developing Nuclear Warhead in Semnan and Shahrud
May 2025	Eyvanekey Site, southeast of Tehran
June 2025	The Kavir (Desert) Plan replacing the AMAD Plan



Mrs. Maryam Rajavi,
President-elect, National
Council of Resistance of Iran

Keynote Speaker

Maryam Rajavi, born on December 4, 1953 in Tehran, is a metallurgical engineer by training and a long-time leader of Iran's democratic opposition. After graduating with honors from Sharif University of Technology, she joined the People's Mojahedin Organization of Iran (PMOI/MEK), first as a student activist against the Shah and then as an official in the organization's student and social departments after the 1979 revolution. She ran for parliament in 1980, later becoming co-leader and then Secretary-General of the PMOI, and in 1993 was elected President-elect of the National Council of Resistance of Iran (NCRI), a parliament-in-exile that advocates a secular, non-nuclear republic based on universal suffrage.

She is known for articulating the "Third Option" — rejecting both war and appeasement in favor of democratic change by the Iranian people — and for her Ten-Point Plan, which envisions a future Iran founded on political pluralism, separation of religion and state, and the abolition of the death penalty.

A central theme of Rajavi's leadership is women's equality and their role at the forefront of the struggle against Iran's religious dictatorship. Under her direction, women have taken key leadership positions in the PMOI and NCRI, now making up more than half of the resistance parliament-in-exile, while she consistently links progress in Iran to women's freedom to choose their beliefs, clothing, and way of life.

Internationally, she has addressed parliaments and conferences across Europe and North America, warning about the threat of Islamic fundamentalism emanating from Tehran and advocating what she calls "democratic Islam" centered on tolerance and equal rights. She has also led major campaigns to remove the MEK from terrorist lists, protect Iranian dissidents in Camps Ashraf and Liberty, and launch a global justice movement for victims of the 1988 massacre of political prisoners, helping turn that atrocity into a live issue in international human-rights forums.



Hon. Mike Pompeo,
70th U.S. Secretary of State



The Rt. Hon. John Bercow,
Speaker of the U.K. House
of Commons (2009–2019)



Amb. Carla Sands, U.S.
Ambassador to Denmark
(2017–2021)



Hon. Patrick Kennedy
(D-RI), Former member
of U.S. Congress



Guy Benson, National
Broadcast Journalist



Opening Remarks

Soona Samsami is the U.S. representative for Iran's parliament-in-exile, the National Council of Resistance of Iran (NCRI). After the Iranian regime's 1981 crackdown on pro-democracy movements, she intensified her human-rights work, especially on women's rights, and helped organize Iranian-American communities across the United States.

Samsami has also played a key role in exposing aspects of the Iranian regime's missile, nuclear, and weapons programs, and has been featured in leading media outlets such as *The New York Times*, *The Wall Street Journal*, *The Hill*, CNN, and C-SPAN. Born in Isfahan, she studied city planning and architecture at Michigan State University.



Welcoming Remarks, An Expert's View

Dr. Sofey Saidi is an accomplished scholar-practitioner in international relations, global governance, and conflict resolution. She earned her Ph.D. in International Relations in Geneva, Switzerland, where she also served as a member of the Globecraft Institute at the Geneva School of Diplomacy and International Relations. Her multidisciplinary academic foundation includes advanced degrees from George Mason University's Carter School for Peace and Conflict Resolution and Duke University's Graduate Program, reflecting a lifelong commitment to understanding complex global systems through both theoretical and applied lenses.

Fluent in Farsi and Spanish, Dr. Saidi brings a uniquely global perspective to her research and teaching. Her expertise spans Middle Eastern and Latin American affairs, ethnic and cultural conflict, and comparative global governance. She has taught Global Politics, Ethnic and Cultural Conflict, and International Relations.

Dr. Saidi's work reflects a deep commitment to fostering cross-cultural understanding, empowering women in global leadership, and advancing dialogue across regions and disciplines. She has been a featured commentator, offering analysis on international affairs, diplomacy, and women's leadership. Dr. Saidi is a member of the National Council of Resistance of Iran.



Convention MC

Ana Sami is an accomplished immigration attorney dedicated to providing experienced legal representation in asylum, adjustment of status, naturalization, consular processing, federal litigation, and various other immigration processes.

Objective

The panel aims to analyze the objective and social conditions in Iran that indicate a society on the brink of transformative change or regime overthrow. It explores the deepening economic, political, social, and environmental crises, and how these have fueled widespread discontent, protest movements, and a growing readiness among the Iranian population to challenge the ruling theocratic regime.

Participants:



Kazem Kazerounian, Ph.D., Dean, UConn College of Engineering (2012–2024); Executive Director, ASME Design Division (2007–2012); Fellow, ASME and AIMBE; Member, Connecticut Academy of Science and Engineering. Dr. Kazerounian is a transformative leader in academic innovation and engineering research, recognized nationally and internationally for his contributions to biomechanics, robotics, and mechanical design. A recipient of numerous national lifetime achievement awards, he has also consulted for more than 50 companies and advised industry and government in design automation, robotics, advanced manufacturing, and strategic planning. As Dean at UConn, he expanded research infrastructure, strengthened industry partnerships, and launched forward-looking programs addressing future technological challenges.



Hossein Saiedian, Ph.D., is a leading figure in computer science as a Professor at the University of Kansas (KU) and a member of the KU Institute for Information Sciences. His significant scholarly output includes over 170 publications in the core areas of computer science, software engineering, and information security. Professor Saiedian's research has attracted support from major organizations, including the NSF. Beyond his recognized excellence in research, evidenced by numerous distinguished awards, his commitment to education is profound: he has mentored and graduated more than 100 master's and doctoral students during his tenure at two institutions.



Sima Yazdani, BSE, MS (Panel Moderator), is the Executive Director of AI Technology & Solutions, with over 40 years of experience in secure IT and database systems. She has authored two technical books and holds six U.S. patents in domain-specific knowledge modeling and AI applications. She is currently a doctorate candidate in Integrated Health Solutions & AI at Arizona State University. Her work focuses on advancing practical AI solutions across healthcare and enterprise environments.



Ashraf Zadshir, MD, is a physician, educator, and clinical researcher based in California. She has held faculty positions at St. George's University and UC Riverside, and currently serves as Core Faculty in a Family Medicine Residency Program. A published author and award-winning leader, she also chairs Clinicians for a Free Iran, advocating for human rights and ethical medical practice.

Objective

This panel explores how Iranian women have become central to the country's democratic struggle. It examines the historical and structural forces, particularly since 1985, that enabled women to assume leadership roles within the organized resistance, and highlights how their sacrifice, resilience, and vision have shaped a credible alternative to dictatorship. The discussion considers how women's leadership is transforming the fight for freedom and positioning them as essential architects of Iran's future.

Participants



Hannane Amanpour, Esq. is an accomplished attorney practicing in family, domestic relations, and business law throughout Northern Virginia. She earned her B.A. in Government and International Politics from George Mason University and her J.D. from The George Washington University Law School, where she served as Senior Articles Editor for the GW Journal of Energy and Environmental Law and was published in Volume 13.1. A lifelong advocate for human rights, Hannane is deeply engaged in advancing women's rights and regularly speaks at public forums in support of a free, democratic, secular, and non-nuclear Iran. Her legal expertise and civic engagement reflect her commitment to justice in both her professional work and broader community.



Dr. Azadeh Sami is a board-certified pediatrician in Fairfax, Virginia, with more than a decade of clinical experience and a sustained commitment to human rights advocacy. She completed her pediatric residency at Sinai Hospital of Baltimore, affiliated with Johns Hopkins University, and holds an M.S. in Public Health from the University of Colorado, grounding her work at the intersection of medicine and public policy. Alongside her clinical practice, Dr. Sami advocates for democracy and women's rights in Iran, working to expose the regime's systemic abuses and amplify the voices of political prisoners. She participates in national forums, policy discussions, and media outreach to highlight Iran's gender apartheid and supports Maryam Rajavi's Ten-Point Plan as a democratic roadmap for a free and pluralistic Iran.



Dr. Ramesh Sepehrrad is a distinguished scholar-practitioner, published author, and leading expert on technology, cybersecurity, and Iran policy. With more than 25 years of experience across public, private, and academic sectors, she has held senior roles advancing enterprise risk management, cybersecurity governance, data strategy, and innovation. Her academic and professional work focuses on conflict resolution, women's rights, and democratic movements in Iran, and she has been widely recognized for her scholarship and service. A trusted voice on national security and human rights, Dr. Sepehrrad regularly briefs U.S. policymakers, contributes to international forums, and publishes on security, human rights, and foreign policy. Her work emphasizes exposing disinformation, documenting systemic abuses, and championing the Iranian people's struggle for a free, democratic, and secular republic.



Dr. Azadeh Zangeneh is an internal medicine physician based in Cleveland, Ohio, dedicated to providing comprehensive adult primary care grounded in evidence-based practice and compassionate treatment. Dr. Zangeneh is committed to preventive care, complex chronic disease management, and advancing health literacy among her diverse patient population. In addition to her medical work, she has been a vocal supporter of the Iranian people's fight against tyranny and champions the movement for a free, democratic, secular, and non-nuclear Iran. Her advocacy centers on amplifying the voices of Iranian women who face systemic discrimination and state-sponsored violence, and she works to raise awareness of their resilience in the face of repression. Inspired by the leadership of women on the front lines of Iran's freedom movement, Dr. Zangeneh uses her platform to highlight the regime's entrenched gender apartheid and call for meaningful international support for Iran's pro-democracy forces.

Messages from political prisoners

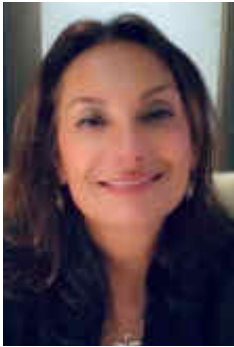
This powerful segment brings the audience directly inside Iran's struggle for freedom. *Voices from Iran* features messages smuggled out from political prisoners—some facing execution—whose courage continues to inspire a nation.

Resistance Units

It also includes exclusive footage of the activities of Resistance Units across Iran, as well as messages from their members risking everything for change. Accompanied by photographs of prisoners on death row and scenes of defiance inside the country, this segment offers a rare and moving glimpse into the heartbeat of Iran's resistance.



Shirin Nariman will be the MC for this section of the Convention.



Shirin Nariman is a former political prisoner from Iran, human rights advocate, and entrepreneur.

At just 15 years old, during the 1979 Iranian Revolution, she became involved in pro-democracy activities and supported the People's Mojahedin Organization of Iran (PMOI/MEK). Less than two years later, she was arrested for her activism enduring severe torture in Evin Prison.

During her imprisonment, Shirin witnessed the regime's brutality firsthand, including the executions of children, elderly women, and pregnant prisoners.

As a business owner and lifelong learner, she continues to expand her knowledge in management and technology while using her voice to promote justice and equality.

Objective

This panel will explore Iran's rapidly evolving political landscape and assess the most realistic pathway to democratic change. Panelists will examine various scenarios proposed for Iran's future—from relying on so-called moderates within the regime, to external pressure, civil disobedience, or military intervention—to determine which approaches have failed to deliver change and which offer a viable route toward freedom. Emphasis will be placed on how Iran's social uprisings, the erosion of regime legitimacy, and the rise of organized resistance networks have created the conditions for genuine, people-driven transformation. The discussion will also address how Iran can move from dictatorship to democracy after the fall of the regime.

Participants



Dr. Firouz Daneshgari is an executive surgeon-scientist with an impressive track record in training, clinical experience, and leadership in healthcare. He completed his medical and surgical training at prestigious institutions including Loyola University of Chicago (1987), University of Chicago (1990), University of Colorado Health Sciences (1997), University of Texas Southwestern Medical Center (1997), and Case Western Reserve University (2013). His academic career includes serving as Assistant Professor of Surgery at the University of Colorado (1998), Founding Director of a Fellowship Program at the Cleveland Clinic (2001), and later holding Professor and Chairman positions at Upstate Medical University in SUNY (2008) and Case Western Reserve University (2009), where he was the Founding Director of the Urological Institute at University Hospitals of Cleveland.



Reza M. Nemovi is a design engineer working at the intersection of aerial-ground robotics, morphological transformation, and advanced control systems. With a foundational role in significant research projects at the California Institute of Technology (Caltech) Aerospace division, he brings expertise in developing multi-mode locomotion systems and transformative robotic platforms. He combines mechanical design, actuation and control with a mission to push the boundaries of robotics that can fly, drive, and morph. Reza has contributed to landmark robotic systems such as an aerially transforming morphobot that transitions mid-flight into a drive mode. He is also a helicopter pilot and certified drone operator.



Dr. Behzad Raofi is currently the NASA Lunar Human Landing System (HLS), Ascent Mission Segment Insight Lead within NASA's Moon To Mars Program at Marshall Space Flight Center (MSFC). Born in Tehran, Iran, watching Neil Armstrong's first moon landing in 1969 instilled the love of space exploration in him since a young age. He came to the United States and completed his Bachelor of Science degree at the University of Texas at Austin with highest honors, followed by Masters Degree in ASE. Since joining NASA/Jet Propulsion Laboratory (JPL) after obtaining his PhD in 1998, Dr. Raofi has worked on many deep space missions as a navigator, including Mars Exploration Rovers Spirit and Opportunity, team lead for the trajectory control for Mars Phoenix Lander Mission, and early navigation support for Mars Science Laboratory Mission (Curiosity).



Saeid Sajadi, MD, is an Internal Medicine Specialist with a Private Practice in Aesthetics. Dr. Sajadi completed his undergraduate studies in Chemistry and Biology at Pittsburg State University. He went on to earn his medical degree from the University of Kansas School of Medicine and completed his residency training at the University of Missouri-Kansas City. He currently practices aesthetic medicine in his private practice. Dr. Sajadi has also pursued graduate studies in International Relations at the master's level at Harvard University, where he is currently conducting research on secessionist versus autonomy movements, with a focus on their commitment to democratic norms and principles.



Farideh Sedighi, Software Engineer, was born in Arak, Iran, and moved to Tehran with her family as a child. She moved to the United States to pursue higher education where she earned her master's degree in computer science from California State University, specializing in software systems, network performance, and automation. At Cisco Systems, Farideh worked as a Test Engineer, focusing on performance and reliability testing for IP telephony and unified communication systems. Farideh, has for decades, fully committed to a free Iran and has played a key role in garnering attention to the plight of the Iranian people and the existence of an alternative to the current theocracy.

Objective

Iran's new generation, from students and activists inside the country to young Iranians shaping policy and media abroad, is now the driving force of the struggle for freedom. This panel highlights how Gen-Z courage, digital organizing, and global advocacy are reshaping Iran's political future and preparing the groundwork for a democratic transition.

Participants:



Mohammadreza Hesami is a senior medical dosimetrist at the U.S. Oncology Network, where he plays a vital role in designing and optimizing radiation treatment plans for cancer patients. Mohammadreza holds a master's degree in medical dosimetry from Southern Illinois University, where he gained advanced expertise in radiation physics, anatomy, and treatment planning systems. With years of clinical experience, he is recognized for his meticulous approach, technical proficiency, and commitment to improving patient outcomes through innovation and teamwork.



Mahrana Mohammadi is a J.D. Candidate at Penn State Dickinson Law, Class of 2027. Serving as Secretary for the Middle Eastern and South Asian Student Association as well as the Christian Law Community, she helps promote dialogue, inclusivity, and faith-based engagement among her peers. In addition to her leadership roles, Mahrana contributes to the academic and professional development of fellow students as a Student Ambassador for Thomson Reuters Westlaw, assisting with legal research and technology training.



Ryan Nasir is a Research and Development Intern and Computer Science student based in San Diego, California. With a strong foundation in programming and cybersecurity fundamentals, he is passionate about designing secure, scalable systems that address real-world challenges. Ryan's technical curiosity is complemented by his deep interest in national security and policy on Iran. He has been actively involved in briefing Members of Congress on critical issues related to national security, policy, and Iran, combining his analytical skills with a commitment to public service and informed decision-making.



Seena Saiedian is a J.D. Candidate at the University of Virginia School of Law, where he is a Karsh-Dillard Scholar, an editor on the Virginia Law Review, and Symposium Chair for the Federalist Society. He graduated from the University of California, Berkeley with a B.S. in Business Administration and minor in Computer Science. Prior to law school, Seena had a career as a private equity analyst at an investment firm. His writing has appeared in national publications including the National Interest, the Federalist, and Townhall.



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A Meeting of Minds: Science Without Borders



Professor Morteza (Mory) Gharib is the Hans W. Liepmann Professor of Aeronautics and Medical Engineering at the California Institute of Technology. He also serves as the Director of the Graduate Aerospace Laboratories and the Director of the Center for Autonomous Systems and Technologies.

Professor Gharib's research is highly interdisciplinary, blending fluid dynamics with biomedical engineering. His work spans conventional aeronautics, vortex dynamics, and advanced flow-imaging diagnostics, including his pioneering work in Digital Particle Image Velocimetry. In the biomedical field, he applies these principles to understand cardiovascular fluid dynamics and embryonic heart development.

This research has led to numerous bio-inspired medical devices, including a novel polymer heart valve and an FDA-approved eye stent for glaucoma patients.

An alumnus of Caltech (Ph.D. '83), Gharib also holds a B.S. from Tehran University and an M.S. from Syracuse University. He joined the Caltech faculty in 1993 after working at the Jet Propulsion Laboratory (JPL) and UC San Diego. He is a member of the National Academy of Engineering and the American Academy of Arts and Sciences and holds over 170 U.S. patents.

The Conversation Partner: Dr. Mohammad H. Tasooji



Dr. Mohammad H. Tasooji is a professor at California State University San Marcos, and is an accomplished engineer, educator, and industry leader. He earned his B.S. in Electrical Engineering from the University of Southern California, an M.S. in Engineering Economic Systems from Stanford University, and a Doctorate in Communication Systems from USC. Dr. Tasooji has held senior management roles at leading technology firms, including Qualcomm, Ericsson, and Nokia. He contributes to clean-energy innovation as CEO of Sienza Energy.

Shaping Iran's Future: The People's Choice for Democracy



Professor Hossein R. Sadeghpour is a prominent theoretical physicist and the Director of the Institute for Theoretical Atomic, Molecular and Optical Physics (ITAMP) at the Center for Astrophysics | Harvard & Smithsonian.

His research focuses on cutting-edge AMO physics, including ultracold atoms, Rydberg interactions, quantum many-body phenomena, and precision measurements. He is highly regarded for his seminal contributions to collision processes, quantum control, and ultracold molecular physics, with his work influencing both laboratory experiments and astrophysical observations.

Sadeghpour holds roles as a Senior Scientist at the Smithsonian Astrophysical Observatory and a Senior Research Fellow at Harvard's Department of Astronomy. Beyond his influential research, he actively mentors the next generation of quantum scientists. Professor Sadeghpour's career reflects a deep commitment to fundamental discovery and advancing emerging quantum technologies. He has also conducted extensive research into the history of Iran.



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